

RG01

Location, Extent and Physiographic Divisions

Rajasthan Geography is 11-15 questions in every paper and this chapter supplies 2-4 of them. Peaks, the Aravalli's extent, boundaries and the four physiographic divisions are the standing favourites; the district count has now become a current-affairs question as well.

This is the map chapter - where Rajasthan sits, who it touches, and how the land is built. RPSC asks it as pure recall: a number, a district, a peak height, a sub-region name. There is no reasoning to do here, only clean memorising, which makes it the cheapest block of marks in the whole Rajasthan Geography section.

Rajasthan - Location & Physiography

Size & extent

- 3,42,239 sq km = 10.41%
- Largest since 2000
- 826 km N-S, 869 km E-W
- 23-30 deg N, 69-78 deg E
- Tropic of Cancer -
Banswara, Dungarpur

Boundaries

- Pakistan 1,070 km - 4 districts
- Radcliffe Line, 1947
- MP longest ~1,600 km
- Punjab shortest ~89 km
- UP - Bharatpur and Dholpur only

Administrative

- 41 districts, 7 divisions
- December 2024 denotification
- Lalit K. Panwar committee
- 8 new districts retained

Western Sandy Plain (61%)

- Marusthali / Thar
- Bagar, Rohi, Nali
- Dunes - barchan, seif, parabolic
- Godwar, Shekhawati, Nagauri upland

Aravalli (9%)

- 692 km, 80% in Rajasthan
- Guru Shikhar 1,722 m, Sirohi
- Borat plateau, Girwa
- Passes - Desuri, Haldighati, Som

Eastern Plain (23%)

- Banas basin / Mewar plain
- Chambal beehad, Dang
- Chappan, Vagad, Kanthal

Hadoti Plateau (7%)

- Vindhyan scarpland
- Deccan lava, black soil
- Mukundara & Bundi hills
- Ukhalda, Vindhyan outliers

Size, shape and where exactly Rajasthan sits

Start with the numbers, because RPSC starts with the numbers. Rajasthan is the largest state of India by area - 3,42,239 sq km, which is 10.41 per cent of the country. It became the largest only on 1 November 2000, when Chhattisgarh was carved out of Madhya Pradesh and MP dropped to second. That date is asked on its own. In population Rajasthan is only seventh, so never mix the two ranks.

- Area 3,42,239 sq km = 10.41% of India's area. Largest state by area since 1 November 2000.
- Latitudinal extent 23 deg 3' N to 30 deg 12' N - a spread of 7 deg 9'.
- Longitudinal extent 69 deg 30' E to 78 deg 17' E - a spread of 8 deg 47'.
- North-south length 826 km; east-west length 869 km; difference exactly 43 km.
- Shape is roughly a rhombus or kite - wider than it is tall.
- The Tropic of Cancer (23.5 deg N) only grazes the extreme south - Banswara and Dungarpur districts.

The four extreme points - learn the village AND the district

Direction	Extreme point	District
North	Kona village	Sri Ganganagar
South	Borkunda village	Banswara
East	Silana village	Dholpur
West	Katra village	Jaisalmer

TRAP

Students flip the two lengths every time. North-SOUTH is 826 km, east-WEST is 869 km - the state is wider than it is tall, so the bigger number goes with east-west. Second trap: the Tropic of Cancer touches Banswara and Dungarpur ONLY; do not add Pratapgarh or Udaipur. Third: the easternmost point is in Dholpur, not Bharatpur.

YAAD RAKHO

Extreme points, clockwise from the top: KOna (north, Ganganagar), Silana (east, Dholpur), BOrkunda (south, Banswara), KAtra (west, Jaisalmer). KO-SI-BO-KA. Ganganagar on top, Banswara at the bottom, Dholpur on the right, Jaisalmer on the left - that is the whole map in one line.

The boundaries - one international, five inter-state

Rajasthan touches one country and five states. Take the international boundary first, because it is short, precise and endlessly asked. It is the Radcliffe Line, drawn on 17 August 1947, and in Rajasthan it runs 1,070 km from Hindumal Kot in Sri Ganganagar in the north to the Shahgarh bulge in Barmer in the south. Four districts front it.

- Pakistan border in Rajasthan = 1,070 km, the Radcliffe award of 17 August 1947.
- Runs from Hindumal Kot (Sri Ganganagar) in the north to the Shahgarh bulge (Barmer) in the south.
- Four border districts - Sri Ganganagar, Bikaner, Jaisalmer, Barmer. Jodhpur does NOT touch Pakistan.
- Jaisalmer has the longest stretch, about 464 km; Bikaner about 168 km.
- Jhalawar has the longest frontage on Madhya Pradesh (about 520 km) and Bhilwara the shortest (about 16 km).
- Udaipur has the longest frontage on Gujarat; Barmer the shortest (about 14 km).
- Districts facing two states at once - Hanumangarh (Punjab + Haryana), Bharatpur (Haryana + UP), Dholpur (UP + MP), Banswara (MP + Gujarat).
- Memory hook for the Pakistan border, north to south - GA-BI-JAI-BAR: Sri Ganganagar, Bikaner, JAIsalmer, BARmer.

The five neighbouring states - length and the districts that touch each

State	Approx. length	Districts of Rajasthan that touch it
Madhya Pradesh	~1,600 km (longest)	Dholpur, Karauli, Sawai Madhopur, Kota, Baran, Jhalawar, Bhilwara, Chittorgarh, Pratapgarh, Banswara
Haryana	~1,262 km	Hanumangarh, Churu, Jhunjhunu, Sikar, Jaipur, Alwar, Bharatpur

State	Approx. length	Districts of Rajasthan that touch it
Gujarat	~1,022 km	Barmer, Jalore, Sirohi, Udaipur, Dungarpur, Banswara
Uttar Pradesh	~877 km	Bharatpur, Dholpur
Punjab	~89 km (shortest)	Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh

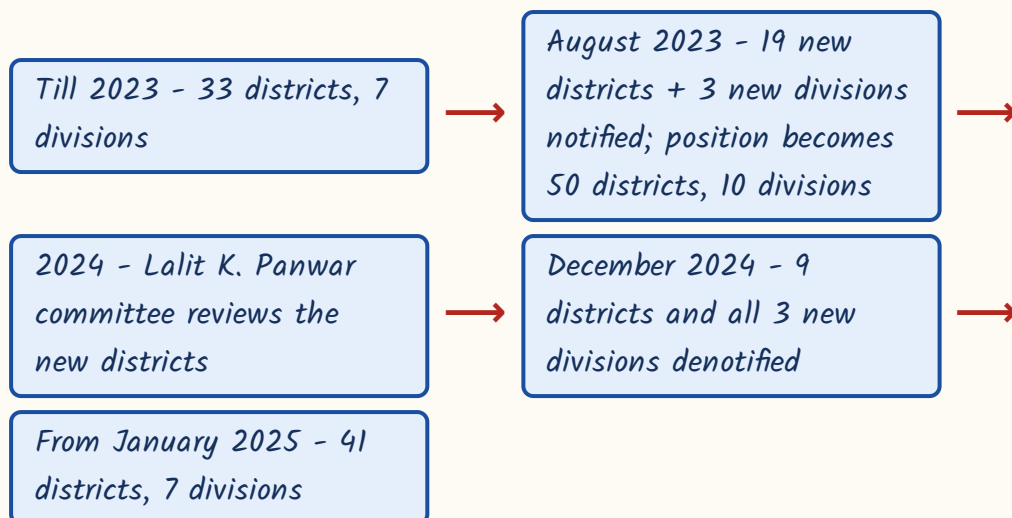
TRAP

Uttar Pradesh touches only TWO districts - Bharatpur and Dholpur - and that is the standard RPSC answer. Be aware the 2023 reorganisation carved Deeg out of Bharatpur, so newer state maps also show Deeg fronting UP and Haryana; the classic two-district answer still stands. Separately, the Haryana list is drawn on the pre-2023 names - Jaipur's frontage now belongs to Kotputli-Behror and part of Alwar's to Khairthal-Tijara.

The administrative map as it stands now - 41 districts, 7 divisions

This is the most volatile part of the chapter, so pin a date to it. Rajasthan had 33 districts and 7 divisions for years. In August 2023 the state notified 19 new districts and 3 new divisions, taking the position to 50 districts and 10 divisions. The next government set up a review committee under Lalit K. Panwar. On its report, in December 2024, nine of those districts and all three new divisions were denotified. The position that took effect from January 2025 - and the one you write in the exam - is 41 districts and 7 divisions.

How Rajasthan got to 41 districts



- The 7 divisions are Jaipur, Jodhpur, Ajmer, Kota, Udaipur, Bikaner and Bharatpur.
- The 3 divisions created in 2023 and abolished in 2024 were Banswara, Pali and Sikar.
- Eight new districts **RETAINED** - Balotra, Beawar, Deeg, Didwana-Kuchaman, Khairthal-Tijara, Kotputli-Behror, Phalodi, Salumbar.
- Nine **DENOTIFIED** - Anupgarh, Dudu, Gangapur City, Jaipur Rural, Jodhpur Rural, Kekri, Neem ka Thana, Sanchore, Shahpura.
- Net effect: $33 + 8 = 41$ districts.
- Place names that moved - Pachpadra is now in Balotra (erstwhile Barmer); Khichan and Bhadla in Phalodi (erstwhile Jodhpur); Makrana, Didwana and Kuchaman in Didwana-Kuchaman (erstwhile Nagaur).

YAAD RAKHO

The eight survivors in alphabetical order run B-B-D-D-K-K-P-S: Balotra, Beawar, Deeg, Didwana-Kuchaman, Khairthal-Tijara, Kotputli-Behror, Phalodi, Salumbar. Four pairs of initials. If a district name is not on that list and did not exist in 2022, it does not exist today.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): Rajasthan stands at 41 districts and 7 divisions, in force since January 2025. Get the two committees straight - the 2023 creation followed the Ram Lubhaya committee, the December 2024 denotification followed the Lalit K. Panwar committee. Any option saying 50 districts or 10 divisions is testing whether you have updated. District creation is a live political issue in the state, so re-check the count in November 2026.

Cultural regions - RPSC often asks place-to-region, not place-to-district

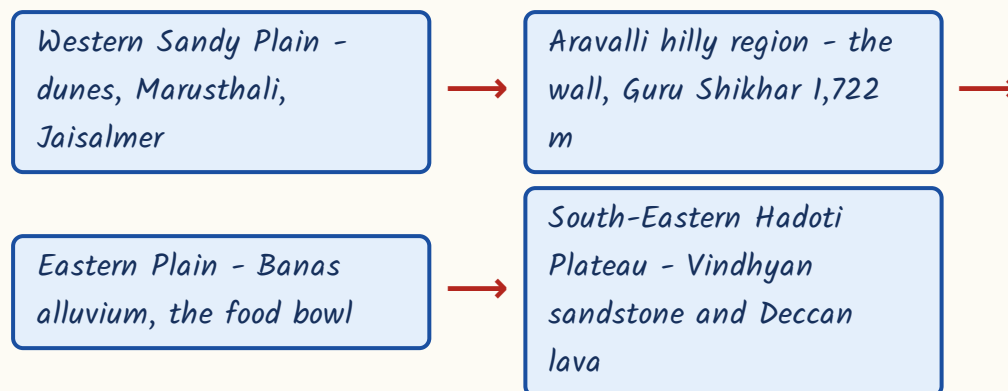
Region	Core districts
Marwar	Jodhpur, Pali, Nagaur
Mewar	Udaipur, Bhilwara, Chittorgarh, Rajsamand
Hadoti	Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar
Shekhawati	Sikar, Jhunjhunu, Churu
Dhundhar	Jaipur
Mewat	Alwar, Bharatpur (the Deeg belt)
Braj	Bharatpur, Dholpur
Vagad	Dungarpur, Banswara
Godwar	Pali, Sirohi, Jalore
Kanthal	Pratapgarh

The four physiographic divisions - the spine of this chapter

Everything else in Rajasthan geography hangs off these four divisions. Learn them west to east, because that is how the land actually changes as you walk across the state - sand first, then the Aravalli wall, then the fertile plain, then the plateau. Learn area share and population share as a pair, because RPSC asks them as a paired statement question. Read the table as a story: the west has

almost two-thirds of the land and only two-fifths of the people, because it is desert. The eastern plain has under a quarter of the land and almost the same number of people, because it is watered and farmed. One line carries all four: area 61 - 23 - 9 - 7, population 40 - 39 - 10 - 11. The population figures for the top two are nearly equal while the area figures are miles apart - that gap IS the desert.

A west-to-east walk across Rajasthan



The four divisions - area and population share

Division	Share of area	Share of population
Western Sandy Plain	about 61%	about 40%
Eastern Plain	about 23%	about 39%
Aravalli hilly region	about 9%	about 10%
South-Eastern Hadoti Plateau	about 7% (smallest)	about 11%

Western Sandy Plain vs Eastern Plain - the contrast RPSC loves

Western Sandy Plain	Eastern Plain
West and north-west of the Aravalli	East and south-east of the Aravalli
About 61% of the area, about 40% of the people	About 23% of the area, about 39% of the people
Rainfall below 50 cm; much of it below 25 cm	Rainfall roughly 50-100 cm
Sandy, desert and saline soils	Alluvial soils - the most fertile in the state
Drainage internal or seasonal - Luni, Kantli, Ghaggar, Kakni	Drained by the Banas, Chambal and Mahi systems
Sub-units - Marusthali, Bagar, Nali, Shekhawati, Nagauri upland, Godwar	Sub-units - Banas basin (Mewar and Malpura-Karauli plains), Chambal beehad, Mahi basin
Lowest population density; Jaisalmer the emptiest district	Highest densities; Jaipur, Bharatpur, Dholpur crowded
Bajra, moth and guar; pastoralism dominant	Wheat, gram and mustard; canal and well irrigation

Division I - the Western Sandy Plain (Thar)

This is the Thar, called Marusthali in the older books. It is India's largest desert. Inside Rajasthan it stretches roughly 640 km north-east to south-west and is 300 to 360 km wide. Do not picture one flat sheet of sand. It has a genuinely arid western half and a semi-arid eastern half, and almost every question comes from the sub-region names. The arid west - rainfall under 25 cm - is the true Marusthali: Jaisalmer, Barmer, Bikaner and the Phalodi belt, with the 'Desert Triangle' of Jodhpur-Jaisalmer-Bikaner at its heart. Bhadla in Phalodi district (erstwhile Jodhpur) sits on this plain and now carries the world's largest solar park. Local terms worth knowing: rocky floors are 'magra', sandy expanses 'dhran', low salt depressions 'ranns' or 'tals'.

The semi-arid Bagar and its four sub-regions

East of the true desert rainfall climbs past 25 cm and cultivation becomes possible. That strip is the Bagar - written Bangar in some texts, and the two words mean the same tract here. The cultivated land within it is called Rohi. Four named sub-regions sit inside the Bagar and every one of them has been examined.

Sub-regions of the semi-arid Bagar

Sub-region	Where	Marker
Ghaggar plain	Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh	Locally called 'Nali'; Kalibangan stands on it
Shekhawati - Torawati	Sikar, Jhunjhunu, Churu	Internal drainage; the Kantli dies here
Nagauri upland	Nagaur, Didwana-Kuchaman	Saline depressions - Didwana, Kuchaman
Luni basin / Godwar	Pali, Sirohi, Jalore	The most humid part of the western plain

Sand dunes of Rajasthan

Dune type	Shape / how it forms	Where
Barchan	Crescent, formed transverse to the wind, horns point downwind	Shekhawati and the Churu belt
Longitudinal (seif)	Long ridges lying PARALLEL to the wind	Maximum in Jaisalmer
Transverse	Ridges at right angles to the wind	Scattered in the western plain
Parabolic	U-shaped, horns point UPWIND - the reverse of a barchan	Bikaner belt
Star	Many arms; forms where wind blows from several directions	Pokhran, Mohangarh

Dune type	Shape / how it forms	Where
Coppice / Nabkha	Sand piled around a bush or shrub	All over the desert

TRAP

Barchan and parabolic are mirror images and RPSC exploits it. Barchan horns point DOWNWIND; parabolic horns point UPWIND. Longitudinal dunes lie PARALLEL to the wind, transverse dunes lie ACROSS it. So a statement reading 'parabolic dunes are crescent-shaped with horns pointing downwind' is false - that describes a barchan. Memory hook: longitudinal is the long word for the long dune with its maximum in the longest desert district, Jaisalmer.

Division 2 - the Aravalli and the hilly region

The Aravalli is the oldest fold mountain range in India - a Pre-Cambrian range worn down to stumps, which is why it is called a relict range. It runs south-west to north-east for about 692 km, from Palanpur in Gujarat through Rajasthan to Delhi, and roughly 80 per cent of that length lies in Rajasthan. It is broad and high in the south, near 150 km wide around Sirohi and Udaipur, and thins into a broken chain of ridges near Jaipur and Alwar - barely 10 km wide by Delhi. Its north-eastern margin is marked by the Great Boundary Fault, where the Aravalli rocks meet the Vindhyan sandstone.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 as a three-statement set - the Aravalli is India's oldest fold mountain range; it runs SW-NE for about 692 km; about 80 per cent of it lies in Rajasthan. All three correct. Aravalli extent has returned in 2018, 2023 and 2024. Learn 692 and 80 per cent as a pair.

The four blocks of the Aravalli, south to north

Block	Districts	What defines it
Abu block (south-west end)	Sirohi	A detached granite mass, an inselberg; Guru Shikhar, Ser, Delwara, Achalgarh; Nakki lake; Rajasthan's only hill station
Southern / Mewar hills	Udaipur, Rajsamand, Chittorgarh, Pratapgarh	Highest and widest; Jarga and Kumbhalgarh; Bhorat plateau; the Girwa basin around Udaipur
Central / Merwara hills	Ajmer, Beawar, Pali, Bhilwara	Narrow ridges; Todgarh, Taragarh, Nag Pahar; divides Marwar from Mewar; most passes lie here
Northern / Alwar-Torawati hills	Sikar, Jhunjhunu, Jaipur, Alwar	Broken, low and discontinuous; Raghunathgarh, Malkhet, Khoh, Harshnath, Bairath

Peaks of the Aravalli – the single highest-peak table in this chapter

Peak	Height (m)	District
Guru Shikhar	1,722	Sirohi - highest in Rajasthan and in the whole Aravalli
Ser	1,597	Sirohi - second highest
Delwara	1,442	Sirohi
Jarga	1,431	Udaipur - highest in Udaipur
Achalgarh	1,380	Sirohi
Kumbhalgarh	1,224	Rajsamand
Raghunathgarh	1,055	Sikar - highest peak of Shekhawati
Malkhet	1,052	Sikar
Todgarh (Morarji)	934	Ajmer belt - Todgarh now falls in Beawar district
Khoh	920	Jaipur - highest in Jaipur district
Taragarh	873	Ajmer
Harshnath	820	Sikar
Nag Pahar	795	Ajmer - the Luni rises here
Bairath / Bhairach	792	Alwar

ASKED IN RAS

Three separate appearances of this one table. RAS Pre 2018 - Guru Shikhar's district and height (Sirohi, 1,722 m). RAS Pre 2016 - peak-to-district matching (Jarga-Udaipur, Kumbhalgarh-Rajsamand, Taragarh-Ajmer, Delwara-Sirohi). RAS Pre 2024 - peak-to-height matching (Guru Shikhar 1,722, Ser 1,597, Achalgarh 1,380, Raghunathgarh 1,055). Descending-order questions come from the same six names.

YAAD RAKHO

Descending order of the big six - G, S, D, J, A, K: Guru Shikhar, Ser, Delwara, Jarga, Achalgarh, Kumbhalgarh. Four of the six are in Sirohi; the two exceptions are Jarga (Udaipur) and Kumbhalgarh (Rajsamand). That one sentence answers most ordering and matching questions on peaks.

TRAP

Harshnath is in SIKAR, not Alwar; Bairath peak is in Alwar. RPSC has used exactly that pair in a 'not correctly matched' question. Guru Shikhar is in Sirohi, never Udaipur - Udaipur's highest is Jarga. And 692 km is the TOTAL Aravalli length, Palanpur to Delhi, not its length inside Rajasthan.

- Bhorat plateau, about 1,225 m, lies between Gogunda and Kumbhalgarh - the highest plateau of Rajasthan.
- Girwa is the saucer-shaped basin around Udaipur, ringed by hills - an Aravalli feature, not a plains feature.
- Passes are called 'nal' or 'dara' - Desuri Nal (the main Marwar-Mewar crossing, Pali side), Haldighati (Rajsamand-Udaipur, battle of 1576), Som, Deobari, Kevada ki Nal, Pipli, Hathi Guda.
- Most passes lie in the central Aravalli, where the range is narrowest.

- Mount Abu (Sirohi) is Rajasthan's only hill station and carries both Guru Shikhar and Nakki lake.

Division 3 – the Eastern Plain

East of the Aravalli the land flattens into alluvium. This is Rajasthan's agricultural heart – under a quarter of the area but nearly two-fifths of the people. Three river basins carve it up, and the sub-region names come straight out of those basins.

- Banas basin – the Mewar plain in its upper part (Bhilwara, Chittorgarh, Rajsamand) and the Malpura-Karauli plain lower down (Tonk, Sawai Madhopur, Karauli).
- Bisalpur dam on the Banas at Todaraisingh (Tonk) waters Jaipur, Ajmer and Tonk from this plain.
- Chambal basin – the river has cut deep gullies into soft alluvium, the ravines or 'beehad'.
- The beehad is best developed in Dholpur, Karauli and Sawai Madhopur; the whole ravine tract is also called 'Dang'.
- Mahi basin – the southern end of the plain, running into the tribal belt.

Mahi basin sub-regions

Region	Districts	Meaning / marker
Chappan plain	Banswara, Pratapgarh	'Chappan' = 56 – named for its 56 streams or villages
Vagad	Dungarpur, Banswara	The Bhil tribal heartland; the Beneshwar fair site
Kanthali	Pratapgarh	The southernmost tract, on the Madhya Pradesh border

TRAP

Three names, three traps. Chappan is Banswara-Pratapgarh, NOT Dungarpur. Vagad is Dungarpur-Banswara. Kanthal is Pratapgarh alone. And the Girwa is an Aravalli feature around Udaipur - a statement that places Girwa in the Eastern Plain is false, and RPSC has set exactly that.

Division 4 - the South-Eastern Hadoti Plateau

The smallest division, about 7 per cent of the state, but geologically the most distinctive. It is called the Hadoti or Pathar plateau and it sits in the south-east - Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar and the Vindhyan belt to their north. It has two clearly different halves, and the exam asks you to separate them.

The two halves of the Hadoti plateau

Vindhyan scarpland	Deccan lava plateau
Lies between the Banas and the Chambal	Lies south and east of the Chambal
Karauli, Sawai Madhopur, Bundi and northern Kota	Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar
Vindhyan sandstone, 350-550 m	Basalt - the northern edge of the Deccan Trap
Red and sandy soils; stone quarrying	Black cotton soil - Rajasthan's soybean belt
Scarps and flat-topped sandstone ridges	Rolling lava-capped uplands

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 as a statement set - the Vindhyan scarpland lies between the Banas and the Chambal; the Deccan lava plateau of Rajasthan has black soil; the Mukundara hills form part of this division. All three correct. The 'between the Banas and the Chambal' wording repeats verbatim, so memorise it in those words.

- Mukundara and the Bundi hills are the arc-shaped ranges of the Hadoti plateau.
- The Chittorgarh plateau and Bhainsrorgarh lie on the western edge of this division.
- 'Dang' - the ravine tract of Dholpur, Karauli and Sawai Madhopur - forms its northern fringe.
- 'Ukhalda' is the local name for the pitted, pot-holed rocky surface of the plateau.
- Detached Vindhyan sandstone hills stand beyond the main scarp in the Karauli-Dholpur belt - the Vindhyan outliers.

TRAP

The Bhorat plateau is NOT part of the Hadoti plateau. Bhorat sits in the Aravalli, between Gogunda and Kumbhalgarh, at about 1,225 m, and it is the highest plateau of Rajasthan. Hadoti is the low south-eastern plateau. RPSC has planted 'Bhorat' as the wrong option in a 'which is NOT part of the South-Eastern plateau' question.

Rocks, the rain-shadow logic, and the last-minute sweep

Two more things get asked and neither takes long. First the rocks. Rajasthan's foundation is Pre-Cambrian - the Aravalli Supergroup and the Delhi Supergroup - overlain by Vindhyan sandstone in the south-east and Deccan basalt in the Hadoti corner. The Malani igneous suite of the Jodhpur-Barmer belt is among the oldest volcanic rock formations in India. Marble, including Makrana marble from Didwana-Kuchaman district (erstwhile Nagaur), comes out of these old metamorphic rocks, and so does the state's lead-zinc, copper and rock-phosphate wealth.

Second, why the west is dry. The Aravalli runs south-west to north-east - which is very nearly PARALLEL to the direction the Arabian Sea branch of the south-west monsoon travels. A mountain only wrings rain out of a wind when it stands ACROSS the wind. The Aravalli stands alongside it. So the moist air slides past the range without being forced up, and the west stays dry while the eastern slopes and the plateau get the rain. That is the entire explanation, and it is set as an assertion-reason question.

ASKED IN RAS

Assertion-reason, in this exact shape - Assertion: the western part of Rajasthan is far drier than the eastern part. Reason: the Aravalli lies parallel to the path of the south-west monsoon's Arabian Sea branch and fails to obstruct it. Both true, and the reason IS the correct explanation. The load-bearing word is 'parallel'.

YAAD RAKHO

Last-week sweep, one breath: 3,42,239 sq km, 10.41 per cent, largest since 2000. 826 north-south, 869 east-west, difference 43. Pakistan 1,070 km, four districts, Jaisalmer longest. MP longest state border, Punjab shortest. 41 districts, 7 divisions. Divisions 61-23-9-7 by area. Guru Shikhar 1,722 m, Sirohi. Aravalli 692 km, 80 per cent in Rajasthan.

REVISION RECAP

1. Area 3,42,239 sq km = 10.41% of India; largest state by area since 1 November 2000.
2. Latitude 23 deg 3' N - 30 deg 12' N; longitude 69 deg 30' E - 78 deg 17' E.
3. 826 km north-south, 869 km east-west, difference 43 km; shape a rhombus.
4. Extreme points - Kona (Sri Ganganagar) N, Borkunda (Banswara) S, Silana (Dholpur) E, Katra (Jaisalmer) W.
5. Tropic of Cancer clips only Banswara and Dungarpur.
6. Pakistan border 1,070 km along the Radcliffe Line, Hindumal Kot to the Shahgarh bulge; four districts, Jaisalmer longest at about 464 km.

7. MP longest state border (~1,600 km), Punjab shortest (~89 km); UP touches only Bharatpur and Dholpur.
8. As of September 2026 Rajasthan has 41 districts and 7 divisions - 9 districts and 3 divisions denotified in December 2024 on the Lalit K. Panwar committee's report.
9. Retained new districts - Balotra, Beawar, Deeg, Didwana-Kuchaman, Khairthal-Tijara, Kotputli-Behror, Phalodi, Salumbar.
10. Division shares by area - Western Sandy Plain 61%, Eastern Plain 23%, Aravalli 9%, Hadoti 7%; by population 40, 39, 10, 11.
11. Thar is India's largest desert; desert triangle Jodhpur-Jaisalmer-Bikaner; the Ghaggar plain is locally 'Nali'.
12. Dunes - barchan horns downwind, longitudinal parallel to the wind and commonest in Jaisalmer, parabolic horns upwind, star dunes at Pokhran-Mohangarh.
13. Aravalli - India's oldest fold range, 692 km SW-NE, about 80% in Rajasthan, Great Boundary Fault on its north-eastern margin.
14. Peak order - Guru Shikhar 1,722, Ser 1,597, Delwara 1,442, Jarga 1,431, Achalgarh 1,380, Kumbhalgarh 1,224.
15. Peak districts - Guru Shikhar/Ser/Delwara/Achalgarh in Sirohi, Jarga in Udaipur, Kumbhalgarh in Rajsamand, Raghunathgarh and Harshnath in Sikar, Bairath in Alwar.
16. Bhorat (about 1,225 m) is the highest plateau, in the Aravalli; Girwa is the Udaipur saucer; Mount Abu is the only hill station.
17. Passes - Desuri Nal, Haldighati, Som, Deobari, Kevada ki Nal; most lie in the central Aravalli.
18. Eastern Plain - Mewar and Malpura-Karauli plains on the Banas, Chambal beehad in Dholpur-Karauli-Sawai Madhopur, Mahi basin with Chappan (S6), Vagad and Kanthal.
19. Hadoti - Vindhyan scarpland between the Banas and the Chambal plus the black-soil Deccan lava plateau; Mukundara and Bundi hills; Ukhaldia surface; Vindhyan outliers in the Karauli-Dholpur belt.
20. The Aravalli runs parallel to the Arabian Sea monsoon branch and so fails to block it - that is why western Rajasthan is dry.